UNIT 8 Providing Information

When you send a letter providing information to customers, be sure to answer their specific questions. After you answer the questions, give the customer additional information about your company and its products and services.

Before you write the letter, make sure you are giving the right information to the right person. You may be answering many requests at the same time, and not all customers have the same needs.

GETTING STARTED

1. Read the e-mails between two customer service representatives at Click Camera Company. Note that different companies are requesting different information and services.
2. Complete the Customer Service Checklist.

From: "Ari Marquez" <ari@click.net>
To: "Michael Salgado" <michael@click.net>
Subject: Requests for information
Date: Tue, Mar 20, 20— 16:23

Since we introduced our new camera, we've been getting a lot of requests for more information. I started a checklist to make sure we keep track of what our potential customers want. New Prints sent me an e-mail yesterday requesting 100 brochures and a display stand. (Are the brochures back from the printer yet?) Inside Photo asked me this morning to ask a sales rep to call. All the reps are at a meeting and won't be able to return calls until Friday.

From: "Michael Salgado" <michael@click.net>
To: "Ari Marquez" <ari@click.net>
Subject: Re: Requests for information
Date: Tue, Mar 20, 20— 17:35

Today, I received requests for brochures from Marvel Film, Digital Zip, and Media Top. Bea Gomez of Camara.com sent an e-mail on March 18; she wants a sales rep to call, and she also wants to get info on promotional materials. Unfortunately, the brochures won't be ready until next week. This afternoon, I'll fax a promotional flyer to each of them and tell them the brochures will be sent on March 27. I'll also tell them about our new processing service.

CUSTOMER SERVICE CHECKLIST

Client	Brochures Requested/Sent	Promotional materials Requested/Sent	Call from sales rep Requested/Made
New Prints	(1) _____	(6) _____	(12) _____
Inside Photo	(2) _____	(7) _____	Mar 20 / Mar 23
Marvel Film	Mar 20 / Mar 27	(8) _____	(13) _____
Digital Zip	(3) _____	(9) _____	(14) _____
Media Top	(4) _____	(10) _____	(15) _____
Camara.com	(5) _____	(11) _____	(16) _____

Model Fax: Providing Information

Look at the different elements of a fax providing information.

FAX

To: Bea Gomez, New Products Department, Camara.com
From: Michael Salgado, Customer Service Department, Click Camera
Subject: The XL-Lite digital camera
Date: March 20, 20—
Pages: 1
Message _____

Dear Ms. Gomez:

Opening →

Thank you for your e-mail of March 18 expressing interest in Click Camera's new digital camera, the XL-Lite.

Focus →

The camera will be available this October, and the cost will be approximately three hundred and fifty dollars ($350.00).

I will be forwarding next week a brochure on the camera. Jim Markham, one of our sales representatives, will be in touch with you on Friday, March 23, to discuss the promotional services and discounts we offer our distributors.

Action →

I am also forwarding information on our new video camera, the Digicam. Mr. Markham will provide more information on this product when you speak with him.

Closing →

If there is anything else I can help you with, please do not hesitate to contact me. Your business means a great deal to Click Camera, and we appreciate the opportunity to provide you with quality cameras.

Again, thank you for your inquiry.

Sincerely yours,

Michael Salgado

Michael Salgado
Customer Service Representative

Useful Language

Thank you for your e-mail of _____.
The _____ will be available _____.
I will be forwarding _____.
We appreciate the opportunity to _____.
Again, thank you for your inquiry.

Composing Your Message

The body of a fax providing information generally has four parts.

Part	Content	Example
Opening	Acknowledge the initial correspondence.	Thank you for your e-mail of March 18 expressing interest in Click Camera's new digital camera, the XL-Lite.
Focus	Provide the information requested.	The camera will be available this October, and the cost will be approximately three hundred and fifty dollars ($350.00).
		I will be forwarding next week a brochure on the camera. Jim Markham, one of our sales representatives, will be in touch with you on Friday, March 27, to discuss the promotional services and discounts we offer our distributors.
Action	Provide additional information.	I am also forwarding information on our new video camera, the Digicam. Mr. Markham will provide more information on this product when you speak with him.
Closing	Offer additional help and thank them for their inquiry.	If there is anything else I can help you with, please do not hesitate to contact me. Your business means a great deal to Click Camera, and we appreciate the opportunity to provide you with quality cameras.
		Again, thank you for your inquiry.

Practice 1 In each question, two of the sentences are appropriate to use in a letter providing information. Circle the letters of the two sentences.

1. **Opening**
   a. Thank you for your letter of June 3rd inquiring about our new Digicam digital video camera.
   b. We are pleased to have the opportunity to respond to your request for more information on our digital cameras.
   c. This is your last chance to buy a camera that uses film.
2. **Focus**
   a. We wondered why you want a sales representative to call you.
   b. The promotional materials you inquired about will be ready on Friday.
   c. We are sending you, under separate cover, a distribution agreement.
3. **Action**
   a. Part of our expanding product line is a mobile phone that takes and sends photos over the phone lines.
   b. We hope you will continue to take good photos.
   c. I am sending a catalog of software developed for our digital cameras.
4. **Closing**
   a. I look forward to working with you in the future.
   b. I'll call you if we want to sell you a camera.
   c. If I can answer any other questions, please call me on my direct line.

Well SAID

The expression *sent under separate cover* means sent separately. Material that doesn't fit in an envelope with a letter is put in a larger envelope or a box and sent separately. Also people may send material separately because the material isn't ready or because they want to contact the recipient again. The letter tells the recipient that the additional material is coming.

Writing Your Message

Clarifying Numbers

When you write numbers in a business letter, it is a good idea to spell out the number in words. Spelling out the number helps to clarify the information.

The camera will be available this October, and the cost will be approximately *three hundred and fifty dollars ($350.00).*

Here are some examples of spelling out numbers in letters.

Quantity	Clarification	Amount	Clarification
5 boxes	five (5) boxes	$6.42	six dollars and forty-two cents ($6.42)
10 gross	ten (10) gross	$3,500	three thousand five hundred dollars ($3,500)

Practice 2 These sentences have unclear information. Ask for clarification. Write out the number first, and follow it with the number in parentheses.

1. Unclear The total is thirty-two dollars ($3.20).

   Clarification Is the total thirty-two dollars ($32.00) or *three* dollars and *twenty* cents ($3.20)?

2. Unclear We will need six (60) boxes of printer paper.

   Clarification Do you want six (_____) boxes of printer paper or sixty (_____) boxes of printer paper?

3. Unclear Please send us one (100) dozen brochures.

   Clarification Do you need _____ (_____) dozen brochures or _____ (_____) dozen brochures.

4. Unclear We asked that payment be received no later than 01/02.

   Clarification Is payment due by _____ 1st or _____ 2nd?

5. Unclear Please submit the report on the fifteenth of every month (for example, June 5).

   Clarification Are reports to be submitted on the _____ (_____) or the _____ (_____) of every month?

6. Unclear I ordered four (40) boxes of envelopes.

   Clarification Did you order _____ (_____) or _____ (_____) boxes of envelopes?

Commas with Conjunctions

Use a comma when you combine two sentences with a conjunction (*that, and, or, nor, yet*). The comma always comes before the conjunction.

The camera will be available this October, *and* the cost will be approximately three hundred and fifty dollars ($350.00).

Practice 3 Combine the following sentences into one sentence. Choose the correct conjunction, and use a comma.

1. I am enclosing the price list with this letter. I am forwarding the catalog under separate cover. (*and* / *or*)

   I am enclosing the price list with this letter, and I am forwarding the catalog under separate cover.

2. A sales representative will e-mail you. She will telephone you. (*yet* / *or*)

   _____

3. We do not have the 999X camera. We have a newer model. (*but* / *nor*)

   _____

4. We appreciate your order. We hope to work with you again. (*or* / *and*)

   _____

5. The brochure is ready now. The camera will be sent next week. (*yet* / *but*)

   _____

Also and *In Addition*

Use the words *also* and *in addition* when you write about more than one action. These words provide continuity and rhythm in a letter.

Also comes before the action verb. *In addition* usually comes at the beginning of a sentence.

I am forwarding a brochure.
I am *also* forwarding information on our new video camera.
In addition, I am enclosing a list of our distributors.

Practice 4 Write new sentences that provide continuity. Use the words provided.

1. I will be sending you our new brochure when it is available.
   also *free samples*

   I will also be sending free samples.

2. We are shipping the new cameras this week.
   In addition *the software*

   _____

3. I look forward to answering any questions you might have.
   In addition *to working with you in the future*

   _____

4. I am attaching a price list to this letter.
   also *an order form*

   _____

5. I am enclosing information on the camera you inquired about.
   In addition *information on our new video camera*

   _____

Letter Practice 1

Complete the sentences in this letter. Use the words below.

addition	hesitate	further	separate
custom-made	inquiry	pleased	your

December 10, 20—

Mr. Roberto Caracciolo
Design 80
Piazza della Republica, 17
20124 Milano
Italy

Dear Mr. Caracciolo:

Thank you for (1) _____ letter of December 1. We, too, are excited about our line of Memphis furniture reproductions.

I am (2) _____ to tell you that all reproductions are labeled and cannot be confused with the original Memphis furniture we produced in the 1980s. In (3) _____, each reproduction is stamped with the date it was produced.

I am sorry that we cannot fulfill your request for custom orders of fabric or wood at this time. Perhaps we will do this in the future. Our Roma line of fine furniture can be (4) _____. A Roma catalog will be sent to you under (5) _____ cover.

If you have any (6) _____ questions, please do not (7) _____ to contact me directly.

Again, thank you for your (8) _____.

Sincerely yours,

Jouris Knockaert

Jouris Knockaert
President, Memphis Design

Letter Practice 2

Lester Freed sent a letter providing information. The shaded boxes show ten places where he made errors. Write the correct word or punctuation above the errors.

Metia Mobile Technology

Michelin House
81 Fulham Road
London, SW3 6RD
United Kingdom

April 21, 20—

Marian Chu
Wireless Accessories
Building 2-A, Floor 3
Walland Industrial Park
(1) Walland TN 37886

Dear Ms. Chu:

(2) Thank you for you're inquiry about our new cell phone, the Metia 9444.

(3) as you requested, I am sending under separate cover our accessory catalog.

(4) I also am sending the price list.

(5) You will be hearing from ours U.S. sales manager, Marcia Jansen, to

(6) discussing volume discounts and any other concerns you have. She will be

(7) sending you a video to our latest television commercials, which you might find interesting.

(8) We look foreword to working with Wireless Accessories and appreciate the

(9) opportunity to being of service.

(10) Again, thank you for your inquisition .

Sincerely yours,

Lester Freed

Lester Freed
Product Information Specialist

Letter Practice 3

On a separate piece of paper, reply to the letter that you wrote in Unit 7. Make up the prices, sales discounts, and information about the promotional materials.

Words and Expressions to Know

Look at this list of words and expressions that were used in the unit. Their definitions are in the glossary at the end of the book.

clarification	forward	initial	price list
continuity	fulfill	inquiry	return
flyer	in touch	order form	under separate cover